

## **Overcalls**

Because of the Defensive element, the most important requirement for an Overcall is that you have a good suit, one that you'd like partner to lead. Keep in mind:

- a 5-card or longer suit with honor strength

- 9-16 points to overcall at the 1-level

- 11-16 points to overcall at the 2-level

## **Takeout Doubles**

There are three kinds of Takeout Double:

- opening hand strength, no more than 2 of opponent's suit, at least 3 in all other suits
- strong Overcall type, at least 17 points and a good suit. Double, then bid the suit.
- strong Notrump type, 19+ points, stopper in their suit. Double, then bid notrump.

Responding to a Takeout Double

- 0-8 points, bid your best suit as cheaply as possible

- 9-11 points, jump in your best suit

- 12 or more points, cue-bid the opponent's suit

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 1NT

Declarer: North

Lead:  4

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead:  2

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4 

Declarer: South

Lead:  3

Board: 4

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 

Declarer: West

Lead:  10

**Board 1**

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 9  
 ♥ 10 9 5  
 ♦ K Q 10  
 ♣ A 9 3 2

♠ A 8 6  
 ♥ K Q J  
 ♦ A J 9 7  
 ♣ K Q 4



♠ 7 4 3  
 ♥ A 8 3  
 ♦ 5 4 3 2  
 ♣ 10 7 5

♠ J 10 5 2  
 ♥ 7 6 4 2  
 ♦ 8 6  
 ♣ J 8 6

NORTH has 20 points, excellent ♦ stoppers and a balanced hand. She is two points too strong to overcall 1NT. Instead, she doubles.

SOUTH has an awful hand - but since he is forced to bid he says 1♠, assuming NORTH wants to hear his best suit.

NORTH now bids 1NT, showing the balanced 19-21 point hand. SOUTH passes, of course.

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
| 1♦           | Dbl   | Pass | 1♠    |
| Pass         | 1NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 1NT by North |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♦4     |       |      |       |

**Board 2**

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 6 2

♥ 6 5

♦ A Q 3

♣ 9 8 7 4

♠ A 10 3

♥ 9 7 4 3

♦ 10 9 2

♣ Q 5 2



♠ Q 7 4

♥ A Q 10

♦ K J 7 5

♣ A K 6

♠ 9 8 5

♥ K J 8 2

♦ 8 6 4

♣ J 10 3

EAST has a 19 point balanced hand, including a stop in ♥s. He plans to double, then bid NT. (see Deal 9)

WEST has 10 points though, so he jumps to 2♠.

In theory EAST could now bid 2NT to continue the description of his hand, but he might as well go ahead and bid 3NT instead.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Dbl

Pass

2♠

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♥2

**Board 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 6  
 ♥ K 7 3 2  
 ♦ A 8 7 6  
 ♣ 10 8 3

♠ K J 4 2

♥ A 8 5

♦ K J 3 2

♣ J 2



♠ 9 7

♥ Q J 10 9

♦ 9 5 4

♣ K Q 6 5

♠ A Q 10 5 3

♥ 6 4

♦ Q 10

♣ A 9 7 4

With a 5-card ♠ suit and 13 points SOUTH should overcall 1 ♠.

NORTH has 13 points and four ♠s. If SOUTH had opened, NORTH's hand would be good enough to insist on game. But since SOUTH overcalled, NORTH merely invites with a jump to 3 ♠.

SOUTH has better than a minimum overcall so she accepts the invitation and bids 4 ♠.

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              |              | 1 ♥         | 1 ♠          |
| Pass         | 3 ♠          | Pass        | 4 ♠          |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 4 ♠ by South |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♥3     |              |             |              |

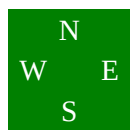
**Board 4**

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 3  
♥ K Q 9 8 6 4  
♦ A 5 2  
♣ 9 5

♠ 10 9 8 2  
♥ A  
♦ K 10 8 4 3  
♣ 8 4 2



♠ K J 6 4  
♥ J 10 7 5  
♦ 6  
♣ A K J 3

♠ A 7 5  
♥ 3 2  
♦ Q J 9 7  
♣ Q 10 7 6

EAST has a very minimum Takeout Double of 1♦. But what it lacks in strength, it makes up for with perfect distribution.

WEST has 13 points and only wants to play in one contract, 4♥.

EAST passes happily.

| West       | North | East | South |
|------------|-------|------|-------|
|            | 1♦    | Dbl  | Pass  |
| 4♥         |       |      |       |
| All Pass   |       |      |       |
| 4♥ by West |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠10  |       |      |       |